



REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL FOR RECRUITMENT SERVICES

The City of Florence, Colorado is accepting proposals from interested, well-qualified and experienced professional search firms to provide executive search services for the position of City Manager. This request is intended to gather multiple proposals to evaluate which firm best fits the needs of the City and City Council in the hiring of a City Manager.

General Information

Florence is a city with a population of approximately 4000, located in Fremont County, Colorado and is organized under Colorado Law as a Council-Manager form of government. A Section 200 statutory city, Florence has an appointed City Manager, and a City Council made up of an at-large Mayor and six ward-based council members. Presently, Florence is under the direction of an Interim City Manager, and is moving forward with an entirely new city council elected in August, 2022. Florence is the hub of the regional water system, providing treated water and distribution to the adjacent towns of Williamsburg, Rockvale, Coal Creek and parts of unincorporated Fremont County. For more information on Florence access the following websites: cityofflorence.colorado.gov or cityofflorence.colorado.gov/city-council

Proposal Review and Award Schedule

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| • RFP opens, notice on website and local paper | October 18, 2022 |
| • RFP due and closes on | November 17, 2022 |
| • Search firm review by City Council in workshop | November 21, 2022 |
| • Search firm selected approved by City Council | December 5, 2022 |

Due Date and Submission Instructions

Respondents to this RFP shall submit completed proposals in a sealed envelope, clearly marked with **"Proposal for Recruitment Services – Florence City Manager"** and the name of the firm submitting the proposal. An original and two (2) copies of the proposal must be submitted by 4:00 pm on Thursday November 17, 2022, to the following address:

**City of Florence
City Clerk's Office
600 West 3rd Street
Florence, CO 81226**

All inquiries or questions concerning this RFP should be directed to the Florence City Clerk, Cortlyne Huppe at 719-784-4848 x224 or cortlyne.huppe@florencecolorado.org.

Objective:

Using the attached Job Search Goals, prepare a proposal tailored to find the most qualified City Manager candidates to meet the needs of Florence and City Council.

Scope of Services – all subject to Colorado OML and candidate confidentiality statutes

1. Conduct preliminary visit(s) to Florence to meet individually with City Council and City Staff members to help refine the job description, identify City needs and develop the candidate profile.
2. Hold at least one focus group meeting with community members, businesses and organizations to further identify needs and refine the candidate profile.
3. Create an agreed upon candidate recruitment profile.
4. Using the Job Search Goals, timeframe targets, and candidate profile as a guide, develop:
 - the application process and timeline, including preliminary application questions, and
 - the selection process and timeline
5. Recruit a pool of candidates who qualify based on the profile and present initial round of candidates to the Hiring Committee (2 Council and 3 Staff) – including reference lists and screening results.
6. Assist the Hiring Committee and City Council narrow the pool to no more than three (3) finalists with completed background checks on or before March 31, 2023
7. Assist the City Council with finalist meet and greet and interviews in open session in or before April, 2023.
8. Provide contract negotiation and transition assistance to hire City Manager on or before April 30, 2023.

Required Proposal Contents - format is flexible

- A cover letter introducing the company/firm and the individual who will be the primary contact person.
- Introduction - a brief profile of the firm, past experience in City Manager searches (emphasize Colorado experience), and information on the person/team members who will be responsible for assisting Florence in the search.
- Outline your standard search methodology/procedures and explain how it will meet our Job Search Goals, and comply with Colorado open meeting laws and candidate information confidentiality statutes.
- Proposed timeline for initial applications, screening of applicants, selection of finalists, and selection of City Manager.
- Proposed cost of services with description of fee structure/breakdown. Provide cost options if applicable.
- Include client references with emphasis on Colorado and similar sized cities.
- Provide any applicable insurance and warranty information.

Rejection of Proposals

- Florence may reject any and all proposals if the proposals do not include any of the required documents or components as noted above, or for any other reason. City officials may, at their sole and absolute discretion, postpone or cancel this solicitation process, waive any irregularities or technicalities, and/or determine the criteria and process whereby proposals are evaluated.
- There is no expressed or implied obligation for the City of Florence to reimburse responding firms for any expenses incurred in preparing proposals in response to this request.

Evaluation of Proposals

- Proposals will be reviewed by the City Council in workshop setting open to the public. The council may request additional information or request virtual communications for clarification if needed.
- Final evaluation and selection will be based on, but not limited to, any or all of the following
 - Compliance with RFP
 - Understanding of City needs and unique situation
 - Clear and complete Scope of Services
 - Ability to complete the work within the time specified
 - Qualifications of the firm
 - Cost

Contract Development

The City will conduct final contract discussions and negotiations with the firm selection by the City Council with the assistance of the City Attorney. This contract will be funded out of the 2023 City budget.